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37 STRAIGHT MONTHS. RENTS KEEP FALLING.

The national median rent dropped again in August, and renters are walking into fall with real leverage for the first time in years.

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**\$1,699. THAT'S THE
NEW NATIONAL
MEDIAN RENT.**

Down 0.9 percent from a year ago, per Realtor.com's August 2026 report. It's still \$227 above where rent sat in August 2019, but the direction has been the same for over three years.

NEARLY HALF OF LISTINGS NOW COME WITH SOMETHING EXTRA.

Realtor.com's August 2026 Monthly Rent Report puts the national concession rate at 43.5 percent of studio, one-, and two-bedroom listings across the 50 largest metros: free weeks of rent, waived fees, or a reduced deposit. In Denver, 71.9 percent of listings carried one. In Austin, 70.7 percent. Senior Economist Jiayi Xu's report frames it plainly: renters are entering fall with more choices and more negotiating room than they've had at any point since the market peaked in 2022. The math that used to favor the landlord in the lease conversation has been tilting the other way for three straight years.

WHAT TO DO DIFFERENTLY WITH RENTERS RIGHT NOW:

- 1** **Tell renter clients they have room to ask.**
In markets running near 70 percent
- 2** **concessions, most listings already include one. Coach them to ask before they sign, not after.**
- 3** **Bring the concession number into the buy-versus-rent conversation.**
A renter weighing a
- 4** **purchase should know their current lease has more give in it than it did two summers ago,**
- 5** **which changes the urgency math on both sides.**
- 6** **Use the national trend as a Chicago-agnostic opener.**
"Rent has fallen nationally for over
- 7** **three years straight" is a real conversation starter with an investor or a first-time buyer,**
- 8** **and it's honestly a national figure, not a local one, so frame it that way.**

THE TAKEAWAY

**RENTERS HAVE
LEVERAGE RIGHT
NOW. MAKE SURE
YOURS KNOW IT
BEFORE THEY
RESIGN THE LEASE.**

Thirty-seven months of falling rent is not a blip. It's the market they're negotiating in today.